Coronary Heart Disease

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Written by: Lára Marie McIvor
Reviewed by: Lucy Kirkham
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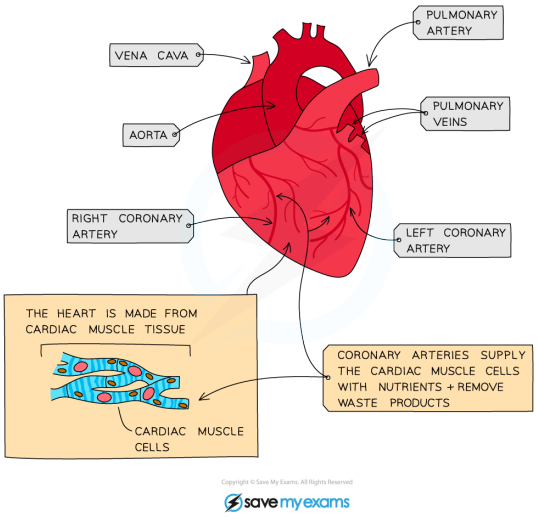
Coronary Heart Disease



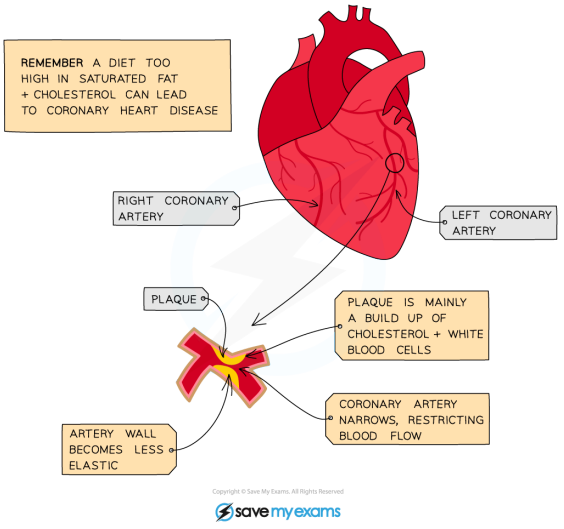
The coronary arteries

- The heart is made of **muscle cells** that need their own supply of blood to deliver oxygen, glucose and other nutrients and remove carbon dioxide and other waste products
- The blood is supplied by the **coronary arteries**

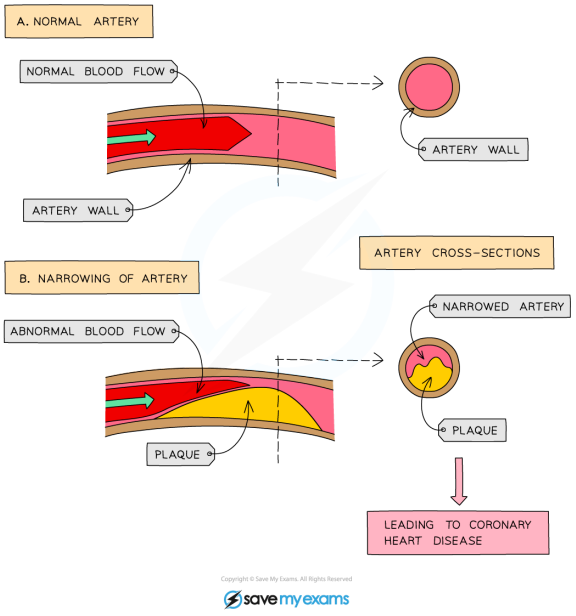
Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

they should be and therefore cannot stretch to accommodate the blood which is being forced through them - leading to **coronary heart disease**

- **Partial blockage** of the coronary arteries creates a restricted blood flow to the cardiac muscle cells and results in severe chest pains called **angina**
- **Complete blockage** means cells in that area of the heart will not be able to respire and can no longer contract, leading to a **heart attack**



Buildup of plaque in the coronary arteries



Effect of narrowing of arteries

Risk Factors for CHD Table

	PLAQUES
STRESS	WHEN UNDER STRESS, HORMONES PRODUCED CAN **INCREASE BLOOD PRESSURE**, INCREASING THE CHANCE OF A BLOCKAGE IN THE CORONARY ARTERIES
SMOKING	NICOTINE IN CIGARETTES WILL CAUSE BLOOD VESSELS TO BECOME NARROWER, **INCREASING BLOOD PRESSURE** WHICH WILL CAUSE THE BUILDUP OF FAT GLOBULES. IF THIS OCCURS IN THE CORONARY ARTERY, THIS WILL CAUSE CORONARY HEART DISEASE
GENETIC PREDISPOSITION	STUDIES SHOW THAT PEOPLE WITH A **HISTORY OF CORONARY HEART DISEASE IN THEIR FAMILY ARE MORE LIKELY TO DEVELOP IT THEMSELVES**, SUGGESTING IT PARTLY HAS A GENETIC BASIS
AGE	THE RISK OF DEVELOPING CORONARY HEART DISEASE **INCREASES** AS YOU GET OLDER
GENDER	**MALES** ARE **MORE LIKELY** TO DEVELOP CORONARY HEART DISEASE THAN FEMALES

Diet, Exercise & Coronary Heart Disease

Reducing the risks of developing coronary heart disease

- **Quit smoking**
- **Diet – reduce animal fats** and eat more fruits and vegetables - this will reduce cholesterol levels in the blood and help with weight loss if overweight
- **Exercise regularly** - again, this will help with weight loss, decrease blood pressure and cholesterol levels and help reduce stress

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